

French

External assessment: oral examination

2008/19753

General information

This document contains information for the external assessment of the oral examination component in French.

In 2010, all Year 12 students who have completed at least two Stage 2 or two Stage 3 units in the French course will be required to take part in an oral examination to receive marks for the oral component of the external examination.

The Curriculum Council will supervise and conduct the external assessment of the oral examination of candidates undertaking Stage 2 and Stage 3 units. This will take place in a centralised metropolitan location, ensuring standardised conditions and marking comparability.

Further advice on matters related to the administration of Curriculum Council assessment will be published in the Curriculum Council WACE circular. Teachers should also refer to the WACE examination policy published in the WACE manual and on the Curriculum Council website.

Teachers are responsible for ensuring that the syllabus requirements are met. This includes following the Curriculum Council assessment guidelines and making sure candidates are adequately prepared for the oral performance. Teachers must ensure they are using the currently accredited course.

External examination weightings

In French the external examination weightings for both Stage 2 and Stage 3 are as follows:

Oral examination	(30 minutes)	30%
Written examination	(two and a half hours)	70%

Reporting achievement

For each unit, schools will be required to submit a mark out of 100 to the Curriculum Council. The school course mark will be calculated by the Curriculum Council by averaging the mark out of 100 for the two units studied in Year 12. The examination mark (a combination of the oral component and the written component) will statistically moderate the school course mark. In 2010, the Curriculum Council will report a WACE course mark which is determined from the moderated school course mark and the standardised examination mark. For the purpose of ranking students for tertiary entrance, the average of the moderated school course mark and the standardised examination mark will be scaled.

Principles

1. The marking process preserves the anonymity of the candidate and the candidate's school.

This requires that:

- candidates will be identified only by their randomly allocated student number
- marking occurs in central locations where candidates cannot be identified with a particular school.

2. Markers will apply a consistent standard to assess the candidate's work.

This requires:

- separate marking guides for Stage 2 and Stage 3 units
- attendance at a training meeting prior to the commencement of marking
- trial marking of work to ensure a common understanding of the marking guide.

3. Double marking of candidate's work will be carried out.

This requires that:

- each marker marks the work independently
- where necessary, the Chief marker will reconcile significant differences
- the Chief marker will ensure marking consistency throughout by monitoring the marking process
- marking of oral performance examinations will be concluded prior to the commencement of the written examinations.

Structure of the Oral examination for Stages 2 and 3

Stage 2 Oral examination

The oral component of the Stage 2 examination is divided into two parts: discussion of two stimulus texts followed by general conversation.

Part A: Stimuli for prompted dialogue and questions (approximately 4 minutes)

This section which is worth 10 marks involves:

- a prompt bag
- a print/visual text
- focus questions
- responses in French

Candidates choose **one** 'prompt bag' of items, which is used to guide discussion and to prompt dialogue. Candidates also choose **one** authentic print/visual text relating to the context of units 2AFRE and 2BFRE and organised around the three nationally required themes of The Individual, The French-speaking Communities, and The Changing World. Candidates answer the focus questions provided.

Part B: General conversation (approximately 8 minutes)

This section which is worth 20 marks involves:

- an interview
- open-ended questions
- responses in French

Candidates are engaged in general conversation on topics within their interest and experience, and organised around Stage 2 unit content. Questions asked are open-ended, allowing candidates to give their own opinion and point of view.

Notes may be made as prompts and may be brought into the interview room.

Candidates leave all materials with the marker before leaving the interview room.

A different set of stimulus materials is provided for each of the days the oral examination is held.

Stage 3 Oral examination

The oral component of the Stage 3 examination is divided into two parts: discussion of one stimulus text followed by general conversation, including one nominated youth/world issue.

Part A: Stimulus for discussion (approximately 4 minutes)

This section which is worth 10 marks involves:

- a print/visual text
- focus questions
- responses in French

Candidates choose **one** print/visual text. Candidates answer and discuss focus questions provided with the text and share ideas and opinions, and make comparisons between Australia and francophone countries. The authentic print/visual texts relate to topics, scenarios or issues relevant to the unit content in 3AFRE/3BFRE and are organised around the three nationally required themes of The Individual, The French-speaking Communities, and The Changing World.

Part B: General conversation, including one nominated youth or world issue (approximately 8 minutes)

This section which is worth 20 marks involves:

- one nominated youth or world issue
- an interview
- open-ended questions
- responses in French

Candidates nominate **one** youth or world issue for discussion with the markers. Candidates are to engage in in-depth discussion/questioning, share ideas and opinions on topics, scenarios or issues within their interest and experience, and relevant to the units' content. Candidates may bring in prompts or tools. Questions are open-ended where possible.

Notes relating to the stimulus may be made as prompts and may be brought into the interview room. Candidates leave both stimulus material and hand-written notes with the marker before leaving the interview room.

A different set of stimulus materials is provided for each of the days the oral examination is held.

Examination instructions for candidates

The central venue for the oral examinations for 2009 will be advised by the Curriculum Council. Candidates should arrive at the venue 20 minutes *before* the scheduled time of the examination. The total time allocated for the oral examination is 30 minutes (15 minutes of preparation and 15 minutes interview). This time includes 3 minutes for reconciliation of marks by the markers.

Procedure

Candidates are taken from the waiting area and assigned firstly to a preparation room and then to the examination room. Whilst in the preparation room candidates are supervised by a Curriculum Council appointed examination supervisor.

While in the preparation room, candidates are provided paper to prepare responses to the stimulus texts (given to the candidates by the supervisor for both Stage 2 and Stage 3 examinations). Texts will contain a minimal amount of reading. Focus questions are provided with stimulus materials to guide candidates' preparation. Candidates are allowed to make notes as prompts as required. Dictionaries are **not** allowed during the preparation time and are **not** permitted in the interview room.

The notes made during the preparation time may be brought into the interview room. Notes for the chosen youth/world issue are **not** allowed.

Candidates are to bring their student number to the preparation and examination rooms. At the start of the examination, candidates are asked to state their student number to the markers. Exams are recorded on digital voice recorders for equity/parity.

Once candidates have completed their examination, they must leave the examination area. Candidates who have completed the examination should **not** have contact with those waiting to be examined.

Marking

Appointment of markers

The Curriculum Council will appoint a Chief marker who will be responsible for the external assessment process and training. Teachers may apply to be external markers. External markers are employed by the Curriculum Council and are therefore responsible to the Curriculum Council through the Chief marker. The Curriculum Council will allocate, in consultation with the Chief marker, a set number of candidates per marker. These candidates will be randomly allocated according to the candidate's Curriculum Council student number.

The marking process

The markers will work collaboratively with the Chief marker and under the direction of the principles of external assessment defined by the Curriculum Council.

The Chief marker sets the standards and this will be based strictly on the criteria set down in the marking guidelines. Exemplar materials will be selected by the Chief marker and used to exemplify standards and levels of oral communication achievement. Marking of the work will be undertaken by two independent markers.

A numerical scale will be used to assess oral response performance in terms of:

- linguistic resources (vocabulary and grammar)
- comprehension
- relevance and depth of response
- interaction
- fluency and clarity.

Refer to sample marking keys in Appendices 1 and 2 of this booklet.

Judgements are compared and a process of reconciliation is undertaken under the direction of the Chief marker. All independent marks and reconciled marks are recorded and submitted to the Curriculum Council by the Chief marker.

The Chief marker is required to prepare a formal written evaluation report which is based upon the established Curriculum Council criteria of:

- adherence to protocols and processes
- attention to administrative processes
- implementation and adherence to established oral communication standards for the subject
- other relevant comments.

Confidentiality of candidate marks is vital and must not be breached. External markers must not be involved in the marking of candidates from their own school and must immediately disclose if they recognise a candidate once he/she enters the interview room.

Stage 2 marking guidelines (oral communication)

Linguistic elements and accuracy				
10-9	8-7	6-5	4-3	2-1
Communicates using a very high level of grammatical accuracy, and a wide range of vocabulary and sentence structures. Demonstrates some inaccuracies in mode and/or syntax which do not affect meaning.	Communicates using a range of vocabulary, language structures and complex sentences with some accuracy and control. Demonstrates a range of inaccuracies in expression, grammar or syntax which do not affect meaning.	Communicates using a limited range of linguistic resources through short responses with a range of inaccuracies in grammar and vocabulary which do affect meaning.	Communicates using limited range of vocabulary and short sentences. Uses simple language structures with pauses and errors.	Communicates using simple or incomplete sentences characterised by set formulae, limited vocabulary, interference of English/first language syntax or vocabulary and frequent pauses and errors.
Score:				
Relevance and depth of response				
10-9	8-7	6-5	4-3	2-1
Communicates relevant ideas, opinions and information supported by a range of interesting examples or experiences. Manipulates language creatively to inform, engage and convince or persuade audience. Sequences and structures ideas and information coherently.	Presents relevant ideas and information with some supporting examples. Manipulates language with some degree of authenticity and creativity to inform and engage. Sequences and structures ideas and information effectively.	Presents a range of ideas and information relevant to the task. Manipulates language but has some difficulty to express own ideas and opinions effectively. Organises information and ideas adequately.	Presents a limited range of ideas and information that are not always relevant to the task. Demonstrates limited evidence of the ability to organise information and ideas.	Presents comments and information not relevant to the task. Not able to express own opinions and ideas adequately. First language interference in vocabulary and sentence structures.
Score:				
Fluency and pronunciation				
5	4	3	2	1
Communicates confidently and fluently with excellent intonation and pronunciation. Uses appropriate 'fillers' to maintain fluency in the target language when 'think time' is required.	Communicates effectively, with good degree of fluency and correct intonation. Uses consistently clear and comprehensible pronunciation; speech flows.	Maintains satisfactory communication with some pauses, repetition and inaccuracies. Pronunciation is highly comprehensible, but may show some hesitation in relation to conventions of conversation, such as turn taking.	Maintains a very basic level of communication with many pauses and errors in pronunciation and intonation which may hamper communication.	Uses single words, set formulae and anglicisms to express information. Frequent silences and errors in pronunciation interfere with communication. May not respond at all.
Score:				
Comprehension and interaction				
5	4	3	2	1
Comprehends quickly, responding spontaneously and without hesitation to all questions and comments from marker including more complex questions. Interacts with marker using body language (where relevant) and correct register (e.g. <i>tu/vous</i>). Expresses enthusiasm and shows involvement.	Comprehends and responds appropriately to most questions from marker, including those of a medium level of complexity. Speaks with some spontaneity. Interacts with marker using body language (where relevant) and correct register. Expresses interest in the topic and/or conversation.	May hesitate and needs time for reflection, but responds appropriately to most questions. Has trouble comprehending more complex questions. Interacts with marker using some body language (where relevant) and mostly correct register. The conversation is mostly directed by the marker and lacks spontaneity.	Responds with difficulty to most questions from marker and has trouble understanding meaning / responds inappropriately. Needs clarification or rephrasing of questions. Little use of body language and uses incorrect register. Minimum involvement or engagement with the topic.	Frequent prompting and repetition or rephrasing of questions needed; silences due to lack of comprehension. Coherent conversation difficult. No interaction with marker. No involvement or engagement with the topic.
Score:				

Total /30

Stage 3 marking guidelines (oral communication)

Linguistic elements and accuracy				
10-9	8-7	6-5	4-3	2-1
Communicates using a very high level of grammatical accuracy, and a wide range of vocabulary and complex sentence structures. Demonstrates ability to use alternative ways of saying things and carry out self corrections.	Communicates using a reasonable range of vocabulary, language structures and more complex sentences with some accuracy and control. Demonstrates some inaccuracies in expression, grammar or syntax (verb tenses, genders) which do not affect meaning.	Communicates using a limited range of linguistic resources and sentence structures characterised by repetition and a range of inaccuracies in grammar and vocabulary which do affect meaning.	Communicates using very limited range of vocabulary and responds using short sentences. Uses simple language structures with pauses and significant errors (mostly verb tenses and genders).	Communicates using single words or incomplete sentences characterised by set formulae, frequent pauses and a high level of inaccuracies, influenced by English or first language syntax and vocabulary.
Score:				
Relevance and depth of response				
10-9	8-7	6-5	4-3	2-1
Presents and develops relevant information associated with stimulus, questions or examiner's comments. Supports original ideas and opinions with examples and/or own experiences. Demonstrates excellent command of language to inform, engage or persuade. Sequences and structures ideas and information effectively.	Presents relevant ideas and information associated with stimulus, questions or examiner's comments and gives some supporting examples. Manipulates language with some degree of authenticity and creativity to inform and engage. Sequences and structures ideas and information coherently.	Presents a range of ideas and information associated with stimulus, questions or examiner's comments. Manipulates language but has some difficulty to express own ideas and opinions coherently. Organises information and ideas adequately.	Presents a limited range of ideas and information that are not always associated with stimulus, questions or examiner's comments. Demonstrates limited evidence of the ability to organise information and ideas.	Presents comments and information not relevant to the task. Not able to express own opinions and ideas adequately. First language interference evident in vocabulary and sentence structures.
Score:				
Fluency and pronunciation				
5	4	3	2	1
Communicates confidently and fluently with excellent intonation and pronunciation. Uses appropriate 'fillers' to maintain fluency in the target language when 'think time' is required.	Communicates effectively, with good degree of fluency and correct intonation. Uses consistently clear and comprehensible pronunciation; speech flows.	Maintains satisfactory communication with some pauses, repetition and inaccuracies. Pronunciation is highly comprehensible, but may show some hesitation relating to conventions of conversation, such as turn taking.	Maintains a very basic level of communication with frequent pauses and errors in pronunciation and intonation. Frequent silences in conversation.	Uses single words, set formulae and anglicisms to express information. Hesitation and errors in pronunciation interfere with communication. May not respond at all.
Score:				
Comprehension and interaction				
5	4	3	2	1
Comprehends quickly and, possibly with some anticipation, responds spontaneously and without hesitation to all questions and comments from marker including more complex questions. Interacts with marker using body language (where relevant) and correct register (<i>tu/vous</i>). Expresses enthusiasm and involvement in the topic and conversation.	Comprehends and responds appropriately to most questions from marker, including those of a medium level of complexity. Speaks with some spontaneity. Interacts with marker using body language (where relevant) and correct register. Expresses interest in the topic and conversation.	May hesitate and needs time for reflection, but responds appropriately to most questions. Has trouble comprehending more complex questions. Interacts with marker using some body language (where relevant) and mostly correct register. The conversation is directed by the marker and lacks spontaneity.	Responds with difficulty to most questions from marker and has trouble understanding meaning or responds inappropriately. Needs clarification and rephrasing of questions. Demonstrates little or inappropriate use of body language and uses incorrect register. Minimum involvement or engagement with the topic.	Frequent prompting and repetition or rephrasing of questions needed; silences due to lack of comprehension. Does not pick up on non-verbal cues or nuances of language. Coherent conversation difficult. No interaction with marker. No involvement or engagement with the topic.
Score:				

Total /30